

3.8.3 General Marking Guidance for each PSA

Centres should use the following marking grids in relation to the PSA assessment.

Each skill has a descriptor with a three point scale (0, 1, 2 or 3 marks). The descriptors are hierarchical and different for Unit 3 and Unit 6 to reflect the differing demand of the Units.

Candidates should be awarded marks which reflect their level of performance over the whole course.

Unit 3		
Following instructions and group work	Selecting and using equipment	Organisation and safety
1A Follows instructions in standard procedures but sometimes needs guidance.	1B Uses standard laboratory equipment with some guidance as to the appropriate instrument/ range.	1C Works in a safe and organised manner following guidance provided but needs reminders.
2A Follows instructions for standard procedures without guidance. Works with others making some contribution.	2B Uses standard laboratory equipment selecting the appropriate range.	2C Works in an organised manner with due regard to safety with only occasional guidance or reminders.
3A Follows instructions on complex tasks without guidance. Works with others making some contribution.	3B Selects and uses standard laboratory equipment with appropriate precision and recognises when it is appropriate to repeat measurements.	3C Works safely without supervision and guidance. (Will have effectively carried out own risk assessment.)
Total 3 marks	Total 3 marks	Total 3 marks

Unit 6		
Following instructions and group work	Selecting and using equipment	Organisation and safety
4A Plans and works with some guidance, selecting appropriate techniques and following instructions.	4B Selects and uses suitable equipment, including at least two complex instruments or techniques appropriate to the A2 course.	4C Demonstrates safe working practices in using a range of equipment appropriate to the A2 course.
5A Plans and works without guidance, selecting appropriate techniques and following instructions. Participates in group work.	5B Selects and uses suitable equipment, including more than two complex instruments and techniques appropriate to the A2 course.	5C Demonstrates safe working practices in some of the more complex procedures encountered on the A2 course.
6A Plans and works without guidance, selecting appropriate techniques and following complex instructions. Participates in group work.	6B Selects and uses suitable equipment with due regard to precision, including a wide range of at least 6 complex instruments and techniques appropriate to the A2 course.	6C Consistently demonstrates safe working practices in the more complex procedures encountered on the A2 course.
Total 3 marks	Total 3 marks	Total 3 marks